

A PHENOMENAL FAUNA



O. Herford

BY CAROLYN WELLS
WITH PICTURES BY
OLIVER HERFORD

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PHENOMENAL FAUNA ***

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BY

CAROLYN WELLS

**WITH PICTURES
BY
OLIVER HEREFORD**

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To My Godfather

WILLIAM F. CLARKE

**Books By
CAROLYN WELLS**

**Children of Our Town
Abeniki Caldwell
The Merry-Go-Round
A Phenomenal Fauna**

**THE
REG'LAR
LARK**

THE REG'LAR LARK

The Reg'lar Lark's a very gay old Bird;
At sunrise often may his voice be heard
As jauntily he wends his homeward way,
And trills a fresh and merry roundelay.
And some old, wise philosopher has said:
Rise with a lark, and with a lark to bed.



THE HUMBUG

Although a learned Entomologist
May doubt if Humbugs really do exist,
Yet each of us, I'm sure, can truly say
We've seen a number of them in our day.
But are they real?—well, a mind judicial
Perhaps would call them false and
artificial.

THE POPPYCOCK

THE POPPYCOCK

The Poppycock's a fowl of English breed,
And therefore many think him fine indeed.
Credulous people's ears he would regale,
And so he crows aloud and spreads his
tale.

But he is stuffed with vain and worthless
words;

Fine feathers do not always make fine
birds.



THE HAYCOCK

The Haycock cannot crow; he has no
brains,

No,—not enough to go in when it rains.

He is not gamy,—fighting's not his forte,

A Haycock fight is just no sort of sport.

Down in the meadow all day long he'll
bide,

(That is a little hay-hen by his side.)

THE POWDER MONKEY

THE POWDER MONKEY

A Theory, by scientists defended,
Declares that we from monkeys are
descended.

This being thus, we therefore clearly see
The Powder-Monkey heads some
pedigree.

Ah, yes,—from him descend by evolution,
The Dames and Daughters of the
Revolution.



THE TREE CALF

The sportive Tree Calf here we see,
He builds his nest up in a tree;
To this strange dwelling-place he cleaves
Because he is so fond of leaves.
'Twas his ancestral cow, I trow,
Jumped o'er the moon, so long ago.
But he is not so great a rover,
Though at the last he runs to cover.

THE MILITARY FROG

THE MILITARY FROG

The Military Frog, as well you know,
Is the famed one who would a-wooing go.
And on the soldier's manly breast
displayed,
He wins the heart of every blushing maid.
But, as a frog, I think he's incomplete,
He has no good hind legs that we may eat.



THE FEATHER BOA

This animal of which I speak
Is a most curious sort of freak.
Though Serpent would its form describe,
Yet it is of the feathered tribe.
And 'tis the snake, I do believe,
That tempted poor old Mother Eve,
For never woman did exist
Who could its subtle charm resist.

THE BRICK BAT

THE BRICK BAT

Oft through the stillness of the summer
night

We see the Brick Bat take his rapid flight.
And, with unerring aim, descending
straight,

He meets a cat on the back garden gate.
The little Brick Bat could not fly alone,—
Oh, no; there is a power behind the
thrown.



THE CAT O' NINE TAILS

The Cat O' Nine Tails is not very nice,—
No good at all at catching rats and mice;
She eats no fish, though living on the sea,
And no one's friend or pet she seems to
be.

Yet oft she makes it lively for poor Jack,

—

Curls round his legs, and jumps upon his
back.

THE ROUND ROBIN

THE ROUND ROBIN

Here's the Round Robin, round as any
ball;

You scarce can see his head or tail at all.

He's not a carrier-pigeon, though he brings
Important messages beneath his wings.

And 'tis this freak of ornithology

They mean who say, "A little bird told
me."



THE IRON SPIDER

The Iron Spider is an insect strange,
He loves to stand upon a red-hot range.
Unlike his race, he's not an octoped,
He has but three legs and he has no head.
Had this but been the kind Miss Muffet
saw
'Twould not have filled the maiden with
such awe.

THE BOOKWORM

THE BOOKWORM

The Bookworm's an uninteresting grub,
Whether he's all alone or in a club.
Of stupid books which seem to us a bore,
The Bookworm will devour the very core.
Did Solomon or somebody affirm
The early reed-bird catches the
bookworm?



THE BLACK SHEEP

The Black Sheep is a beast all men should
shun—

He has no fleece yet fleeces every one;
Though without horns, oft with a horn he's
seen;

Though not a lamb, he gambles on the
green.

Perhaps he's not a sheep, as some suggest,
But a grim wolf who's in sheep's clothing
dressed.

TIME FLIES

TIME FLIES

Time Flies are well-known insects; sages
claim

That Tempus Fugit is their rightful name.
When we're on idleness or pleasure bent,
They sting our conscience and our fun
prevent.

We hear them winter mornings ere we
rise,

And oft in fly-time we observe Time Flies.



THE APPLE BEE

In country villages is found
The Apple Bee with buzzing sound.
And when our ears it does regale
We find a sting is in its tale.
As to its food,—the Apple Bee
Is fond of doughnuts, cheese and tea.

THE WELSH RABBIT

THE WELSH RABBIT

See the Welsh Rabbit—he is bred on
cheese;

(Or cheese on bread, whichever way you
please.)

Although he's tough, he looks so mild,
who'd think

That a strong man from this small beast
would shrink?

But close behind him follows the
nightmare,

Beware of them, they are a frightful pair.



THE CRICKET BAT

The Cricket Bat is very often seen
Flying perchance around the village green;
But unlike many other bats, its flight
Is always made by day and not by night.
There may be one exception though,—and
that
Is when it's aimed at some stray
neighboring Cat.

THE COMMON SWALLOW

THE COMMON SWALLOW

The Common Swallow is so swift of
flight,

We scarcely see him ere he's out of sight.

One does not make a summer, it is true,

But many of them cause a fall or two.

The Swallow's strong when he is in his
prime,

And yet a man can down him every time.



THE TOMAHAWK

The Tomahawk's a fearsome bird, we
deem;
Though feathered tribes hold him in great
esteem;
A bird of prey, he whizzes through the air,
And clutches his pale victim by the hair.
Gory and grewsome,—he is the mainstay
Of the historic novel of to-day.

THE JAIL-BIRD

THE JAIL-BIRD

This is a Jail-bird. Isn't it a shame
To keep him in a cage and try to tame
His wild desires for freedom? See him
droop
Behind his bars. He wants to fly the coop.
But to beguile his tedious, lonely hours
Kind ladies bring him nosegays of bright
flowers.



THE ROYAL SEAL

This noble beast's impressive form is seen
'Mong the possessions of a king or queen.
Hard-favored, yet so valuable is he,
He's ever kept beneath a lock and key.
And, since his temper can't find vent in
speech,
He stamps and punches everything in
reach.

THE FIRE DOGS

THE FIRE DOGS

Here are two Fire Dogs—they are queer,
indeed;

They seem to come of a three-legged
breed.

They have no tails, their bark is on their
back;

They hunt in couples, never in a pack.

The day's work over, 'tis a pleasant sight
To find them waiting by the fire at night.



THE MACKEREL KIT

This funny little Mackerel Kit
Is not like other cats a bit;
She cannot mew or scratch or purr,
She has no whiskers and no fur.
Yet, like all cats, her dearest wish
Is just to be filled up with fish;
But (and this isn't so feline)
She always takes them steeped in brine.

THE GOLF LYNX

GOLF LYNX

This is the merry Golf Lynx, as you see;
An amiable beast, and fond of tee.
Indigenous to all the country round,
His snaky length lies prone along the
ground.
It is the fashion o'er this beast to rave,
But have a care, lest you become his
slave.



THE TRAVELING CRANE

The Traveling Crane's a bird, of course,
Yet he possesses wondrous force.
A bird of burden he must be,
He lifts and pulls so mightily.
And sometimes he will grasp his prey,
And with it rise and soar away.
His plumage is not fine, but then,
He's of the greatest use to men.

THE FLYING BUTTRESS

THE FLYING BUTTRESS

The Flying Buttress, every day and night,
Continues in his long, unwearied flight.
He's not a song-bird, but he's said to be
Famed for his beauty and his Symmetry.
He frequents an old abbey or a manse;
The ostrich eats him if he gets a chance.



THE SEA PUSS

In ocean waters the Sea Puss is found,
Cat-like, forever chasing round and round.
She has no claws, but crouching sly and
low
She stealthily puts out her undertow.
And when an old seadog comes in her
way
I'll warrant you there is the deuce to pay!

THE BATTERING RAM

THE BATTERING RAM

This is the Battering Ram, a fearful beast,
I think he weighs a thousand tons at least.
Stronger than any other kind of butter,
He goes his way calmly, without a flutter.
Big as an elephant, bigger than a horse,
He seems the best example of brute force.



THE SPRING CHICKEN

Here's the Spring Chicken. I have heard
They manufacture this queer bird
From bits of leather and of strings
All joined and worked by tiny springs.
Whenever this fine fowl is broiled,
Each of his springs should be well oiled,
Or he may spring across the room
And plunge his carver into gloom.

THE SHUTTLECOCK

THE SHUTTLECOCK

The Shuttlecock's a handsome fowl to see,
His feathers grow straight upward like a
tree.

He cannot crow, but oftentimes his flight
Will reach up to a most astounding height.
He is a gamecock, and, in fighting trim,
There are not many birds that equal him.



THE SAW-BUCK

The Saw-Buck is a fearsome beast.
The tramp objects to it, at least.
When to the housewife he applies
For coffee or for apple-pies,
Right speedily he'll turn and leave her
When he is seized with Saw-Buck Fever.

THE PIGEON TOAD

THE PIGEON TOAD

The Pigeon Toad's a funny little beast,
He's found in every land from West to
East.

The children bring him in, to our amaze,
And though we try to turn him out, he
stays.

He's never seen with soldiers, nor with
fops,
But with the schoolboys how he jumps
and hops.



THE GOLDEN BUCK

Perhaps because it's easily approached,
The Golden Buck's a game that's often
poached.

'Tis sometimes mild, again 'tis strong and
hearty,

It may be found at many a gay stag-party.
No branching antlers this strange beast
adorn,

But with the Golden Buck we take a horn.

THE BUMBLE PUPPY

THE BUMBLE PUPPY

This is the Bumblepuppy. He's quite tame,
Although he's said to be a sort of game.
You scorn him, yet you must—ah, there's
the rub—
Accept him at your table or your club.
He has his points, yet he's a pest, indeed;
I would we could exterminate the breed.



THE WATCH DOG

This useful animal we keep
To guard our treasure while we sleep.
A pointer, not a setter, yet
He's of no use unless he's set.
Gaze on his open, honest face,—
There's no deception in his case.
He is attached to us, 'tis plain,
Though often by a slender chain.

THE GOLD EAGLE

THE GOLD EAGLE

Here's the Gold Eagle. Very rare. They say
This bird is worth ten dollars any day.
He has no wings, apparently, yet I
Or you, or anyone can make him fly.
He's very powerful—held in great esteem;
And money talks, so let the eagle scream.



THE BUGBEAR

Of all the fearsome beasts beneath the sun
The Bugbear is the most appalling one.
At night he comes and hovers o'er our
bed,
Filling us with a nameless fear and dread.
He is not half so terrible by day—
Sometimes he shrinks and dwindles quite
away.

THE IRISH BULL

THE IRISH BULL

Among the stock jokes it is oft averred
The Irish Bull is best of all the heard.
He has no points, he has no head or tail,
But many a jovial party he'll regale.
And all his hearers will with laughter
choke,
Except his brother John, who sees no joke.



THE JAY

'Tis very strange, and yet, upon my word,
This silly fellow thinks he is a bird!
He lives on hayseed,—everywhere he's
found,
But in the country he does most abound.
And at the approach of winter, (more's the
pity),
A flock of jays will migrate to the city.

FOREBEARS

FOREBEARS

Misled by certain signs of form and shape,
Some think we are descended from the
ape.

But recent science now the truth declares
The human race descended from
Forebears.

And since we're so inclined to war, I'll
wager

One of our Forebears was the Ursa Major.



THE HIGH HORSE

The High Horse often takes a foremost
place

Among the winners of the human race.

They say one needs both brawn and brain
to ride him,

And even then 'tis very hard to guide him.

His jockeys gaily prance and boldly scoff,

But soon or late they're sure to tumble off.

The End.

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